

The Employment Reality Report

Why ADAP's Employment Premise Fails — By the Government's Own Numbers

A documented analysis of the structural, medical, and labour-market conditions that make ADAP's employment-supportive framing functionally untenable for the population it serves.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — April 2026 Report Series | Submitted to the Premier, Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services, Minister of Jobs, all Alberta MLAs, federal Minister of Disability Inclusion, and media

The Government of Alberta is investing \$185 million to help 79,000 people with severe disabilities find employment — in a province where employers imported work permit holders at four times the rate of AISH recipients, where the unemployment rate for people with severe disabilities is 73.6%, where 650,000 Albertans have no family doctor, where the children's disability waitlist is three years long, and where the government has simultaneously eliminated the caseworkers who were supposed to coordinate the supports that make employment possible.

The employment premise of ADAP is not supported by the government's own data. This document proves it.

SECTION 1: WHO IS BEING TOLD TO WORK — AND WHO THEY ARE

The ADAP framework rests on a single premise: that a significant portion of AISH recipients are able to work but are being held back by a program that does not reward employment. The government has framed the transition as empowerment — giving people with disabilities the tools to pursue meaningful employment.

Before examining whether those tools exist, it is necessary to understand who the 79,290 people being transitioned actually are — and what the employment data shows about people in comparable situations.

1.1 The Three Groups Within the AISH Population

AISH recipients are not a monolithic group. The employment barriers they face vary significantly — but share one common feature: they are structural, documented, and not resolved by career planning sessions or digital employment supports.

GROUP	DESCRIPTION	EMPLOYMENT REALITY
People who worked and became disabled	Recipients who contributed to the labour market — often for years — before acquiring or developing a disability. Includes CPP-D recipients (16,161 — 20.4% of caseload) who paid into Canada's pension system and became too disabled to continue.	The CPP-D clawback already punishes this group for having worked. A 12-year average employment gap is itself a documented re-entry barrier, independent of all other factors. Retraining programs do not close a gap created by disability.
People with congenital or lifelong disabilities	Recipients whose disabilities were present from birth or early childhood — genetic syndromes, developmental disabilities, severe autism profiles, congenital conditions. Many have never held competitive employment because the structural conditions for it have never existed for them.	Employment for this group requires coordinated multi-specialist care, workplace accommodation, supported employment programs, reliable transportation, and consistent caregiving support for their dependents. None of these are guaranteed under ADAP.
People with intermittent or fluctuating conditions	Recipients who have worked — or could work — but whose conditions do not allow consistent, reliable, full-time employment. Includes people with episodic mental health conditions, immune disorders, and pain conditions that fluctuate unpredictably.	This is the group most genuinely served by an employment-supportive model. But the ADAP framework does not distinguish between a person who could manage 10 hours per week and one who could manage 40. The same employment participation requirements apply to both.

THE DATA POINT THE GOVERNMENT IS NOT CITING: 83.6% of AISH recipients had zero employment income in 2023-24. The government frames this as a problem ADAP will solve. The data suggests it is a reality ADAP does not account for. **People with severe disabilities do not have zero employment income because AISH discourages work.** They have zero employment income because the structural, medical, and caregiving barriers documented throughout this report series make sustained competitive employment impossible for the majority — regardless of what program they are on.

SECTION 2: WHAT THE EMPLOYMENT DATA ACTUALLY SHOWS

The government's ADAP framework assumes that employment supports will bridge the gap between disability and employment. Statistics Canada's 2024 Labour Market Characteristics report — the most current national

data available — shows what that gap actually looks like, and why it cannot be closed with career planning sessions.

2.1 Employment Rates — Persons with Disabilities vs. Without

METRIC	PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES	PERSONS WITHOUT DISABILITIES	GAP
Employment rate — more severe disabilities (2024)	26.4%	~75%+	Nearly 50 percentage points
Employment rate — less severe disabilities (2024)	54.7%	~75%+	~20 percentage points
Unemployment rate (2024)	8.1%	5.6%	2.5 percentage points
Labour force participation — men with disabilities	51.6%	74.6%	23.0 percentage points
Labour force participation — women with disabilities	49.5%	65.4%	15.9 percentage points
Average hourly wage gap (employees with vs. without)	\$2.22/hour less	—	Widening — was \$1.91 in 2023
AISH recipients with any employment income	16.4%	—	83.6% have none

Sources: Statistics Canada — *Labour Market Characteristics of Persons with and without Disabilities, 2024* (released May 2025); Alberta Government AISH Caseload Open Data, September 2025.

The employment rate for persons with more severe disabilities — the population most comparable to AISH recipients — is 26.4%. That means approximately three in four people with severe disabilities are not employed, in a country with one of the most extensive employment support networks in the world.

*The employment rate for people with severe disabilities is 26.4%. **ADAP is being designed on the premise that the majority of AISH recipients can find and sustain employment. Those two statements cannot both be true.***

2.2 Alberta's Own Employment Context — The Market ADAP Recipients Would Enter

METRIC	ALBERTA FIGURE	SOURCE
Alberta general unemployment rate (2024)	7.0% — increased 1.1 percentage points	Statistics Canada / Job Bank Alberta Economic Scan 2024
Alberta PWD unemployment rate (ages 25-64) (2024)	8.9% vs. 7.9% for non-disabled	Job Bank Alberta Economic Scan 2024
Alberta employment rate gap — PWD vs. non-PWD	16.8 percentage points	Statistics Canada 2024 Labour Market Report
Youth unemployment rate Alberta (2024)	14.5% — increased 2.3 percentage points	Job Bank Alberta Economic Scan 2024
Number of unemployed Albertans (2024)	189,400 — increased 24% year-over-year	Statistics Canada / Alberta Economic Scan
Alberta unemployment rate (February 2026)	6.3%	Alberta Job Market Snapshot, February 2026
Full-time employment change (February 2026)	DOWN 17,300 full-time positions in one month	Alberta Job Market Snapshot, February 2026

The ADAP employment premise is being launched into a labour market where general unemployment is 6–7%, youth unemployment is 14.5%, and people with disabilities face an additional 16.8 percentage point employment gap compared to non-disabled Albertans. The jobs that ADAP assumes recipients will obtain are competing with hundreds of thousands of non-disabled unemployed Albertans.

SECTION 3: THE TEMPORARY FOREIGN WORKER CONTRADICTION

On April 1, 2026 — two days before this document was written — the Government of Alberta introduced the Immigration Oversight Act, requiring businesses to register with the province before hiring temporary foreign workers. Minister of Jobs Joseph Schow stated the legislation is about ensuring “*Albertans have first crack at Alberta jobs.*”

This legislation was introduced by the same government that is simultaneously telling 79,000 people with disabilities that they should be preparing for employment. The contradiction embedded in these two positions requires examination.

METRIC	FIGURE	SOURCE
Work permit holders in Alberta (2021)	~45,000	CBC News, April 1, 2026; Minister Schow statement
Work permit holders in Alberta (2025)	~180,000	CBC News, April 1, 2026 — “skyrocketed”
Increase in work permit holders 2021–2025	300% increase — 135,000 additional workers	Calculated from above
Non-permanent residents in Alberta (Jan 1, 2026)	271,024 — ~60% holding work permits	Alberta Quarterly Population Report, December 2024
TFW approvals — business/finance/admin (2018)	166 positive LMIA's	CBC News, June 24, 2024
TFW approvals — business/finance/admin (2023)	2,242 positive LMIA's	CBC News, June 24, 2024
Increase in business/admin TFW approvals 2018–2023	1,251% increase	CBC News — “unique trend”
Government's stated reason for TFW increase	“Cannot find the employees in Alberta” — Minister Schow	CBC News, April 1, 2026

THE CONTRADICTION IN TWO SENTENCES: *The Government of Alberta allowed work permit holders to grow from 45,000 to 180,000 between 2021 and 2025 — because, the government now says, employers “cannot find the employees in Alberta.” The same government is telling 79,000 people with severe disabilities that the barrier to their employment is not structural — it is their benefit program.*

The TFW data reveals an important truth about Alberta's labour market: even employers who were actively looking for workers chose to import labour rather than hire locally. Business, finance, and administration TFW approvals increased 1,251% between 2018 and 2023. These are the clerical, administrative, and support roles that would theoretically be most accessible to people with disabilities who can work in office environments.

If those jobs were available and accessible to local workers — including disabled workers with supportive employment programs — employers would not have needed to recruit internationally at 12 times the prior rate. The labour market was not failing to match disabled workers to jobs because of the AISH benefit structure. It was failing for systemic reasons that ADAP does not address.

WHAT THE IMMIGRATION OVERSIGHT ACT ACTUALLY TELLS US: *Alberta's government introduced legislation on April 1, 2026, stating explicitly that Alberta workers were being bypassed for jobs that should go to Albertans first. July 1, 2026, the same government launches ADAP — telling disabled Albertans they should be seeking employment in that same market. These two policy positions share a calendar but not a coherent theory of the labour market.*

SECTION 4: THE \$185 MILLION QUESTION

Minister Nixon described the \$185 million investment in ADAP employment supports as “unprecedented” and a demonstration of the government's “commitment to invest significantly in helping individuals who want to pursue employment within the disability community.”

This figure deserves examination — both what it buys per person, and what it assumes.

THE \$185 MILLION MATH	FIGURE
Total ADAP employment support investment (Budget 2025)	\$185 million
AISH/ADAP recipients (September 2025)	79,290
Per-person allocation if divided equally	\$2,334 per person
What \$2,334 buys in supported employment (annualized)	Approximately 4–5 weeks of one-on-one employment coaching at market rates
What wraparound supports actually cost per person annually	\$10,000–\$50,000+ depending on complexity of need
Heritage Fund investment return in fiscal 2024-25 (9.6% on \$27.2B)	~\$2.6 billion — 14 times the ADAP employment investment
ADAP employment rules finalization date (as of April 3, 2026)	Not yet set — Ministerial Order coming “later this spring”
Days until July 1, 2026 launch	88 days

THE \$185 MILLION COVERS APPROXIMATELY \$2,334 PER PERSON. *The government's promised wraparound supports — child care, transportation, mental health, career planning, assistive technology, supported job placements — cost far more than \$2,334 per person annually for a population with complex, permanent disabilities. The financial math of the ADAP employment promise does not hold.*

4.1 What “Wraparound Supports” Actually Require — and What Is Currently Available

Nixon's letter and public statements promise wraparound supports including child care, transportation, and mental health supports. Each of these promises must be measured against documented reality.

PROMISED ADAP SUPPORT	WHAT NIXON PROMISED	DOCUMENTED REALITY
Child care	ADAP will provide access to child care supports to enable employment	FSCD waitlist: 3-year average wait for full services. One caseworker managing 400+ families. Government's own auto-reply: “we cannot provide any timelines.”
Transportation	Rural and remote recipients will have access to digital and in-person supports	Alberta has no legislated rural transit standard. AISH recipients without vehicles — many of whom have social anxiety, agoraphobia, or mobility limitations — are already unable to access services 90 minutes away. Digital supports do not substitute for physical transportation to a worksite.
Mental health supports	Employment services will include holistic wraparound supports including mental health	AISH/ADAP do not cover evidence-based mental health treatments: EMDR, DBT, CPT, somatic therapies. Wait time for psychiatry in Alberta: 6–18 months. Alberta's mental health budget: 5.5% of total health spending vs. 12% recommended.
Case management	ADAP clients will work with case managers to create personalized action plans	Individual caseworkers were eliminated in 2024-25. Caseloads documented at up to 200 per worker vs. recommended 90–105. The call centre no one can reach is the current model. Adding 79,000 ADAP employment plans to this system has no identified staffing plan.

PROMISED ADAP SUPPORT	WHAT NIXON PROMISED	DOCUMENTED REALITY
Career planning and job placement	Digital services, career planning, assistive technology, supported job placements	The employment income calculations that govern what recipients can actually earn through these placements will be set in a Ministerial Order “later this spring” — 88 days before launch.

SECTION 5: THE SYSTEMS THAT WOULD MAKE EMPLOYMENT POSSIBLE — AND WHAT HAS HAPPENED TO THEM

Every document in this series has documented the systematic dismantling of the infrastructure that would be required to make employment a realistic outcome for people with severe disabilities. This section cross-references those findings through the specific lens of employment.

5.1 You Cannot Work Without a Doctor

Employment for people with disabilities requires coordinated medical management: prescription oversight, specialist referrals, workplace accommodation letters, crisis response protocols, and regular monitoring of complex conditions. All of this requires a family physician.

- 650,000 Albertans have no family doctor.
- Family practices accepting new patients collapsed from 887 in 2020 to 164 in 2024 — an 81% drop.
- 61% of family physicians are considering leaving the provincial system.
- Without a GP, there is no referral pathway to specialists. No specialist means no coordinated management of the complex conditions that define AISH eligibility.
- Without a GP, workplace accommodation letters cannot be written. Without accommodation letters, many employers will not hire.
- Without a GP, the ADAP medical reassessment form cannot be completed — the same form required to return to AISH if employment fails.

The ADAP transition requires physician-completed forms from a population that largely has no physician. The ADAP employment plan requires medical coordination that largely has no physician to provide it. **These are not separate problems. They are the same problem — and ADAP does not solve either.**

5.2 You Cannot Work Without Stable Mental Health Support

Mental health conditions are the primary qualifying diagnosis for 30.2% of AISH recipients — the second largest group after physical disability. For many others, mental health conditions are secondary diagnoses that

compound physical and cognitive barriers to employment.

- AISH/ADAP health benefits cover physician visits through AHCIP but do not cover the evidence-based treatments that actually stabilize employment-affecting mental health conditions: EMDR, DBT, CPT, somatic therapies, individual DBT, specialized trauma programs.
- Wait times for psychiatry in Alberta: 6–18 months — and psychiatrists can only be accessed through a GP referral that most recipients cannot get.
- Alberta's mental health budget is 5.5% of total health spending. The Mental Health Commission of Canada recommends 12%.
- Alberta has already documented a 47% increase in emergency department visits for psychiatric crises — the most expensive possible point of mental health intervention, and a direct consequence of inaccessible preventive and therapeutic care.

A person with untreated C-PTSD, BPD, or severe depression cannot reliably sustain employment. These are not motivational failures. They are clinical realities. ADAP's employment programming does not include coverage for the treatments that would make employment clinically possible for this population.

5.3 You Cannot Work Without Childcare — and There Is None

Single parents make up 6.8% of the AISH caseload — 5,426 people. The overwhelming majority are women. For this group, the question of employment is inseparable from the question of who cares for their children while they work. For parents of children with severe disabilities, the answer is stark.

- The average wait for full FSCD services in Alberta is three years.
- 58% of families report negative effects from going without FSCD supports — including job loss.
- One FSCD caseworker has been documented managing 400+ families. The recommended maximum is 100.
- No after-school care program in Alberta accepts children with severe ASD, active aggression, flight risk profiles, and cardiac monitoring requirements.
- Nixon's promise of “*child care supports*” through ADAP is being made by the same ministry that has a three-year FSCD waitlist and an auto-reply that says “*we cannot provide any timelines.*”

THE CHILDCARE PROMISE VS. THE CHILDCARE REALITY: *Nixon promised ADAP will provide access to child care supports. The ministry responsible for ADAP also runs FSCD — where the average wait for full services is three years. **These promises are being made by the same office that cannot staff the program it already has.***

5.4 You Cannot Work Without a Caseworker Coordinating Your Supports

Employment support for people with complex disabilities does not happen through a phone app. It requires a human coordinator who knows the recipient's file, their medical history, their housing situation, their children's needs, and their specific barriers. That person was the individual caseworker — now eliminated.

- Individual caseworkers were eliminated province-wide in 2024-25 and replaced with a call centre.
- Caseloads reached up to 200 per worker — more than double the recommended maximum of 90–105.
- The call centre model is documented as inaccessible to people with social anxiety, agoraphobia, and communication-related disabilities — qualifying conditions for AISH.
- The ADAP employment plan requires every recipient to develop a personalized action plan with a case manager. There are not enough case managers to do this now — before the employment load is added.
- Adding 79,000 individual employment action plans to a system already operating at twice recommended caseload capacity has no documented staffing solution.

5.5 You Cannot Work if the Housing Situation Is Unstable

Employment requires a stable address. It requires the ability to sleep consistently, manage daily routines, and respond to workplace demands without the cognitive load of housing crisis. The ADAP transition is happening simultaneously with the following documented housing realities:

- Average 1-bedroom rent in Alberta: \$1,500–\$1,900+/month. AISH pays \$1,940/month. After rent, as little as \$40 remains for all other expenses — before ADAP's \$200/month cut takes effect in January 2028.
- Community housing rent was increased 63% by ministerial order in October 2025 — adding \$221/month to recipients' costs in their last affordable option.
- Edmonton's Civiida waitlist: 10,000+ applicants. Calgary Housing: 6,500+. Neither is measured in months.
- Housing instability is one of the strongest documented predictors of employment failure — not because of motivation, but because unstable housing makes consistent employment attendance structurally impossible.

SECTION 6: THE EMPLOYMENT INCOME MATH — WHAT ADAP ACTUALLY OFFERS

The government's headline employment figure — that ADAP recipients can earn up to \$45,000 while continuing to receive benefits — is technically accurate and functionally misleading. The following analysis uses the government's own figures to demonstrate why.

ADAP EMPLOYMENT INCOME ANALYSIS	FIGURE	SOURCE
ADAP monthly benefit (single)	\$1,740/month	Government of Alberta — ADAP program page, March 2026
Employment income exemption (single)	\$700/month	Government of Alberta — ADAP program page, March 2026

ADAP EMPLOYMENT INCOME ANALYSIS	FIGURE	SOURCE
Current AISH employment exemption (being cut July 1, 2026)	\$1,072/month	Inclusion Alberta; Government of Alberta
New AISH employment exemption (July 1, 2026)	\$350/month	Inclusion Alberta ADAP Fact Sheet, October 2025
At what monthly income does ADAP equal current AISH?	Over \$2,114/month (33 hrs/week at minimum wage — sustained)	Gillian Petit, University of Calgary — CBC News, August 2025
Government's own Case Study 1 result	Recipient earns \$164/month LESS on ADAP than current AISH	ADAP Discussion Guide — independent analysis by Gillian Petit
Maximum earnings while receiving any ADAP benefit	\$45,000/year (\$3,750/month)	Government of Alberta — ADAP program page
At \$3,750/month earned, what is the ADAP benefit?	Substantially reduced — below base rate	Calculated from gradual reduction structure
Detailed ADAP clawback calculation rates	NOT YET SET — Ministerial Order "later this spring"	Minister Nixon letter, April 3, 2026
Alberta minimum wage (October 2025)	\$15.00/hour	Government of Alberta
Hours per week at minimum wage to earn \$2,114/month	~33 hours/week — sustained, without accommodation or health gaps	Calculated

THE \$700 EXEMPTION IS NOT A GAIN. IT IS A CUT. Current AISH employment exemption: \$1,072/month. New ADAP employment exemption: \$700/month. Recipients who currently work are being moved to a program with a LOWER employment exemption than what they have now. This will be finalized in a Ministerial Order coming "later this spring" — 88 days before the July 1 launch.

SECTION 7: THE GOVERNMENT'S OWN CONTRADICTIONS — ON THE RECORD

The following presents documented contradictions between government statements and government data — all drawn from official sources. These contradictions are not matters of interpretation. They are factual.

GOVERNMENT CLAIM	GOVERNMENT'S OWN DATA	SOURCE OF CONTRADICTION
ADAP will help recipients find employment	Employment rate for persons with severe disabilities: 26.4%. 83.6% of AISH recipients have zero employment income — not because of the program structure, but because of documented structural barriers.	Statistics Canada 2024; Alberta Government AISH Open Data
\$185M is an unprecedented investment in employment for disabled Albertans	$\$185\text{M} \div 79,000 \text{ recipients} = \$2,334$ per person. The Heritage Fund grew \$383M in a single quarter. This “ <i>unprecedented</i> ” investment represents less than one month of Heritage Fund investment returns.	Alberta.ca Heritage Fund Q3 2025-26; Budget 2025
Alberta will provide wraparound supports including child care	FSCD — same ministry — has a 3-year average wait for full services. The auto-reply to families: “ <i>we cannot provide any timelines at this time.</i> ”	Inclusion Alberta FSCD Survey, January 2025; FSCD auto-reply publicly documented
Albertans on ADAP can earn more than \$45,000 while receiving benefits — “<i>the highest limit in Canada</i>”	At \$45,000/year (\$3,750/month), ADAP benefits are substantially reduced. The government's own Case Study 1 shows a recipient with \$1,492/month income would have \$164 LESS on ADAP than current AISH.	Gillian Petit, University of Calgary — ADAP Discussion Guide analysis
ADAP was thoughtfully designed based on input from Albertans with disabilities	The specific criteria for AISH vs. ADAP classification were not publicly established before the Bill 12 passage. Employment income calculations will be set by Ministerial Order “ <i>later this spring</i> ” — 88 days before launch.	Bill 12, December 9, 2025; Minister Nixon letter, April 3, 2026
Albertans have first crack at Alberta jobs (Immigration Oversight Act)	Work permit holders in Alberta grew from 45,000 to 180,000 (2021–2025) while the government was designing an employment program for disabled Albertans who “ <i>want to work.</i> ”	CBC News April 1, 2026; Minister Schow statement

GOVERNMENT CLAIM	GOVERNMENT'S OWN DATA	SOURCE OF CONTRADICTION
ADAP will cover one medical assessment for recipients who want to return to AISH	The ADAP medical reassessment requires a physician-completed form. 650,000 Albertans have no family doctor. 164 practices accept new patients province-wide — down from 887 in 2020.	Healthcare Worker Shortage Report; Minister Nixon letter, April 3, 2026

SECTION 8: WHAT AN EMPLOYMENT-SUPPORTIVE PROGRAM WOULD ACTUALLY REQUIRE

This report does not argue that employment support for people with disabilities is wrong. It argues that the specific model Alberta is implementing — applied to the population it is being applied to, with the supports that are actually available, in the labour market that currently exists — will not produce the outcomes it claims.

A genuine employment-supportive disability program would require the following, none of which ADAP currently provides:

- **Guaranteed primary care access:** A person who qualifies for AISH on the basis of a complex permanent disability cannot navigate employment supports without coordinated medical management. Universal GP access for AISH/ADAP recipients is a prerequisite, not an afterthought.
- **Funded evidence-based mental health treatment:** Employment participation for people with C-PTSD, BPD, and severe depression requires clinical stabilization first. Career planning does not stabilize trauma. Covering EMDR, DBT, and CPT would cost a fraction of the emergency system costs generated by not doing so.
- **Real childcare — not a promise:** No employment plan for a single parent of children with severe disabilities can succeed without confirmed, appropriate childcare. The FSCD waitlist must be cleared before ADAP's employment expectations can be applied to single parents.
- **Restored caseworker model:** Personalized action plans require people who know the recipient's file. The call centre model is not capable of delivering individualized employment coordination. Caseworkers must be restored to recommended caseload ratios before employment planning can be meaningful.
- **Voluntary, not mandatory participation:** Employment programming that is a condition of receiving benefits — applied to people with permanent, severe disabilities who have been assessed as unable to work — is not empowerment. It is compliance under financial coercion. Genuine employment support is offered, not required.
- **Honest income math:** The employment income exemption must be set so that working actually improves a recipient's financial position. The government's own Case Study 1 shows ADAP does not achieve this for many recipients. Fix the math before launching the program.
- **Labour market realism:** Design employment programming around jobs that actually exist, are accessible to people with disabilities, and can accommodate the intermittent attendance, accommodation

needs, and medical interruptions that characterize this population. A 33-hour week at minimum wage is not the benchmark. Flexible, supported, part-time employment with real accommodation is.

SECTION 9: WHAT WE ARE ASKING

To the Government of Alberta

- Pause the mandatory employment participation requirements of ADAP until the wraparound supports promised — child care, transportation, mental health — are actually available at the scale and quality required for the population being served.
- Publish the Ministerial Order governing ADAP employment income calculations immediately — not *“later this spring.”* Recipients cannot make informed decisions about the July 1 transition without knowing the financial rules that will govern their income.
- Commission an independent analysis of the \$185 million employment investment against realistic per-person support costs for a population with complex, permanent disabilities. Publish the methodology.
- Address the direct contradiction between the Immigration Oversight Act — which acknowledges that Albertans are being bypassed for jobs — and the ADAP framework, which tells disabled Albertans those jobs are available to them.
- Establish a provincial guarantee of primary care access for AISH/ADAP recipients before implementing employment participation requirements. Employment cannot be expected from people who cannot access the medical coordination required to sustain it.
- Make employment programming voluntary — genuinely supportive and incentivized, not compliance-based. People who are able to work and want to work will use good employment supports without being required to. People who are not able to work should not be required to participate in programming that does not reflect their clinical reality.

To the Federal Government

- Require that Alberta's ADAP employment framework be independently assessed for compliance with the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, specifically Article 27 — the right to work — which requires that the right to work be realized *“on an equal basis with others”* and without discrimination.
- Examine whether mandatory employment programming applied to people with permanent severe disabilities, as a condition of receiving disability income, constitutes a violation of Charter section 15 equality rights — a policy whose burden falls exclusively on people defined by a protected characteristic.
- Formally recognize nurse practitioners as eligible to sign all ADAP-related medical documentation, and fund those assessments as a covered administrative cost of the federal-provincial disability program relationship.

SOURCES AND REFERENCES

- Statistics Canada — “Labour Market Characteristics of Persons with and without Disabilities, 2024.” Released May 14, 2025. statcan.gc.ca. Employment rate severe disabilities 26.4%; unemployment rate PWD 8.1%; wage gap \$2.22/hour; participation rates by gender.
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- Government of Alberta — ADAP Program Page. alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program. \$1,740 benefit; \$700 employment exemption; \$45,000 threshold; July 1, 2026 launch.
- Inclusion Alberta — ADAP Fact Sheet, October 2025. Employment exemption transitions; \$1,072 to \$350 for new AISH; \$700 for ADAP.
- Gillian Petit, University of Calgary — ADAP analysis cited in CBC News, August 21, 2025. Case Study 1 demonstrates \$164/month loss for representative recipient.
- Alberta Government — AISH Caseload Open Data, September 2025. open.alberta.ca. 79,290 recipients; 83.6% with zero employment income; 16,161 with CPP-D.
- Alberta.ca — Heritage Savings Trust Fund Q3 2025-26 Report. \$383M growth in single quarter; \$31.9B total fund value.
- Government of Alberta — Budget 2025. \$185M ADAP employment investment; AISH funding \$1.641B; projected reductions of \$77M over three years.
- Bill 12, Government of Alberta — passed December 9, 2025. Removal of independent appeal rights; criteria not published in plain language before passage.
- Minister Jason Nixon — letter to Genevieve Bissonette, April 3, 2026. Employment income calculations “*later this spring*”; one medical assessment commitment.

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